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Glossary

groaning – crying in pain

dreadful – extremely bad

ice-lollies – flavoured ice or ice cream on a stick

weeny tug – small pull

gas – anesthesia

scream – a very funny thing

ferrying – carrying

queer – strange

writhing – twisting the body from side to side

agony – severe pain

sulking – being sad and silent

blurred – hazy, not clear

1. Complete the summary of the play, choosing the appropriate words from the list given below the passage.

A number of patients wait at the (1) _____ of a dentist's clinic. Everybody is tensed at the thought of a painful (2) _____ being extracted. One of the women is bent on showing everyone her (3) _____. After the arrival of the dentist, Joe, the first (4) _____ is called in. Sometime later, the nurse comes out and goes in with a (5) _____. Everyone is (6) _____ at this, imagining Joe being subjected to a lot of hammering in the process of his tooth being pulled out. Once again the nurse comes out to fetch a large pair of (7) _____ and later on she takes in a (8) _____. A little boy confesses that he pretended to have (9) _____, because he did not wish to go to school. The loud (10) _____ and screeching from within the room makes everyone leave the **(11)** _____, one by one. Finally there are only two women in the waiting room, one of them being Joe's wife. She weeps (12) _____ about her husband. But Joe comes out and explains that he had shifted his (13) _____ to the evening and had been given some pills for the pain. After they leave, the dentist comes out and locates the key of his tool (14) _____. He had been trying to open it using the hammer, the pliers and the hacksaw only in vain. The woman with the photographs is surprised to see that the (15) _____ had moved quickly and she was the next patient to go in.

hammer	**patient**
hacksaw	**cabinet**
frightened	**queue**
worried	**waiting room**
pliers	**tooth**
photographs	**clinic**
toothache	**sawing**
appointment	